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Placement Director: Jaroslav Borovička jaroslav.borovicka@nyu.edu 347-899-6273
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Education

PhD in Economics, New York University, 2021-2027 (expected)
Fields: Macroeconomics, Housing
MA in Economics, Collegio Carlo Alberto (Allievi Program), 2018-2020
MSc in Economics, University of Turin, 2018-2020
BA in Economics, University of Trento, 2015-2018

References

Professor Corina Boar
New York University
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Professor Raquel Fernández
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Professor Guido Menzio
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Sharon Traiberman
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Teaching Experience

Spring 2025, Fall 2025	Introduction to Econometrics, TA
Fall 2022, Fall 2024	Intermediate Macroeconomics, TA
Spring 2023, Fall 2023, Spring 2026, Fall 2026	International Economics, TA

Research Experience and Other Employment

2020-2021	European Central Bank, Trainee, Directorate General Statistics

Honors, Scholarships, and Fellowships

2021-2027	NYU MacCracken Fellowship
2021	Unicredit Marco Fanno Scholarship
2018-2020	Carlo Alberto Allievi Honors Program
2015-2018	University of Trento Honors Program

Research Papers

Declining Fertility and Housing Costs (Job Market Paper)

I study how the cost of family space shapes fertility and what housing policy can do about it. Housing costs are at the center of the public debate on declining fertility: children need space, and young households, who have little savings, find that space costly to pay for. I build a life-cycle model in which households choose whether to have children, whether and how much to rent or own, and how much to save. Buying requires a down payment, and earnings are risky. I calibrate the model to the United States in 2007 and treat the fall in births since then as an exogenous decline in the taste for children. Along the transition to a new steady state with a smaller population, fewer households make housing cheaper, which feeds back into fertility. Because a child is a long commitment, earnings risk weighs on fertility, and lower risk raises births. I then use the model to assess housing policy. Easier mortgage credit could give young households access to the larger homes a child requires, but it does little for births. Policies that change long-term incentives, such as more housing supply and credit for parents, raise fertility, and their effects build up over a generation. Housing policy must therefore be judged by its long-run effects.

Consumption Sorting and Inequality (with Saverio Spinella)

Households cluster in space by income and consumption. We study how spatial inequality shapes local retail prices. In our model, households invest time comparing prices across stores to spend less. A high concentration of retailers makes it easier to find better deals, while a high income reduces the incentive to search for bargains. Retailers respond to their customers' shopping behavior: rich neighborhoods attract more shops, especially those selling high-quality goods. Using NielsenIQ data, we document that households pay more for the same basket in richer neighborhoods, even conditional on their own income. Yet goods favored by richer households are relatively cheaper in richer locations. Retail markets thus respond to income and consumption segregation and sustain it. We use the calibrated model to compare affordability policies. Production subsidies are more progressive than price caps, but price caps are more effective at reducing segregation.

Research In Progress

Frictional Rental Markets and Inequality

Using ACS microdata, I document new facts on the heterogeneity of paid rents across individuals and cities. First, young people tend to pay higher rents and move more frequently, especially in denser and less housing-elastic cities. Second, recent movers—both within and across cities—pay systematically higher rents. These effects are heterogeneous across space and stronger in larger, denser metropolitan areas. To rationalize these patterns, I develop a parsimonious model of directed search in the rental market. The model explains the observed dispersion in paid rents and implies that increases in housing supply would disproportionately benefit younger and more mobile households.

Presentations

2026: DC Search & Matching Workshop*; SaM Annual Conference*; Symposium on Real Estate & Urban Policy — Indiana University/Chicago Fed.
NYU Macroeconomics Lunch; NYU Applied Microeconomics Student Lunch; NYU Stern Macro Lunch.
* Coauthor Presentation.